Elements of Poetry

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POETRY

- A type of literature that expresses ideas, feelings, or tells a story in a specific form (usually using lines and stanzas)

Diction

- The choice of words of the speaker. It deals with what the words mean, what the words imply or suggest. We can arrive at these by looking at their denotative or connotative/associative meanings. The words may be simple, complex,

Figurative Language

Figurative language is words not meant to be taken literally. The words are symbolic. We know these images as metaphor, simile, personification, hyperbole, and others.

Metaphor

- Direct Metaphor
- Comparing two unlike objects or ideas
- My love is a rose

Metaphor, Continued

- Indirect metaphor

- - An indirect comparison between two unlike things.
- “My love has a rosy bloom”

Simile

- A comparison using like or as
- “Life is like a box of chocolates”

Personification

- Giving human qualities to an inanimate object
- “The moon smiled down on the lovers”

Sound Techniques

- Rhyme Scheme
- Alliteration
- Onomatopoeia

Rhyme Scheme

- Heavy is my heart, A
  Dark are thine eyes B
  Thou and I must part A
  Ere the sun rise B

Rhyme Scheme- The pattern in which end rhyme occurs

- **Example:**

Continuous as the stars that shine (A)
And twinkle on the milky way, (B)
They stretched in never-ending line (A)
Along the margin of a bay: (B)
Ten thousand saw I at a glance, (C)
Tossing their heads in sprightly dance. (C)

Alliteration

Repetition of the initial consonant sound

- “She sells seashells at the sea shore”

ALLITERATION

- Consonant sounds repeated at the beginnings of words

If *P*eter *P*iper *p*icked a *p*eck of *p*ickled *p*eppers, how many *p*ickled *p*eppers did *P*eter *P*iper *p*ick?

Onomatopoeia

- A word whose sound imitates its meaning

More onomatopoeia

- “The bee buzzed by my ear “
- “The clock ticked down the final hour”
- “The engine purred while awaiting the green light”

Stanza

- •A unit of lines grouped together •
- •Similar to a paragraph in prose

- Couplet- •A stanza consisting of two lines that rhyme
- Quatrain - •A stanza consisting of four lines

- Mood- the feeling a poem creates for the reader

- Tone - the attitude a poet takes toward his/her subject

Imagery

- •Representation of the five senses: sight, taste, touch, sound, and smell
- •Creates mental images about a poem's subject
- • **Example: "Continuous as the stars that shine and twinkle on the milky way"**

Imagery

- An image is language that describes something that can be seen, heard, touched, tasted, or smelled.
- The images in a literary work are referred to, when considered together, as the work's imagery.

Sight



- The sun’s beams shimmered and danced on the ocean’s gentle waves.

Smell



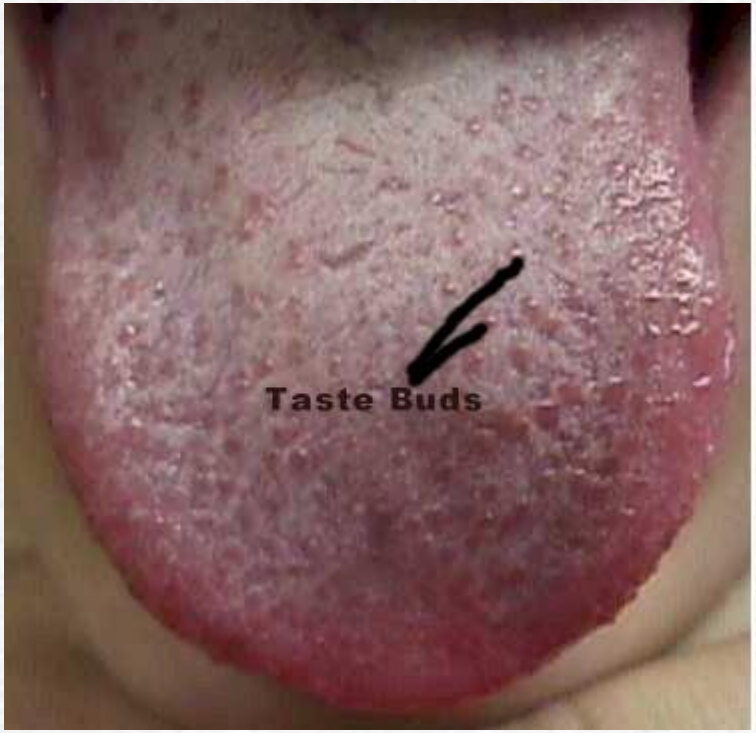
- The fragrant roses drifted through the room like elusive ghosts.

Sound



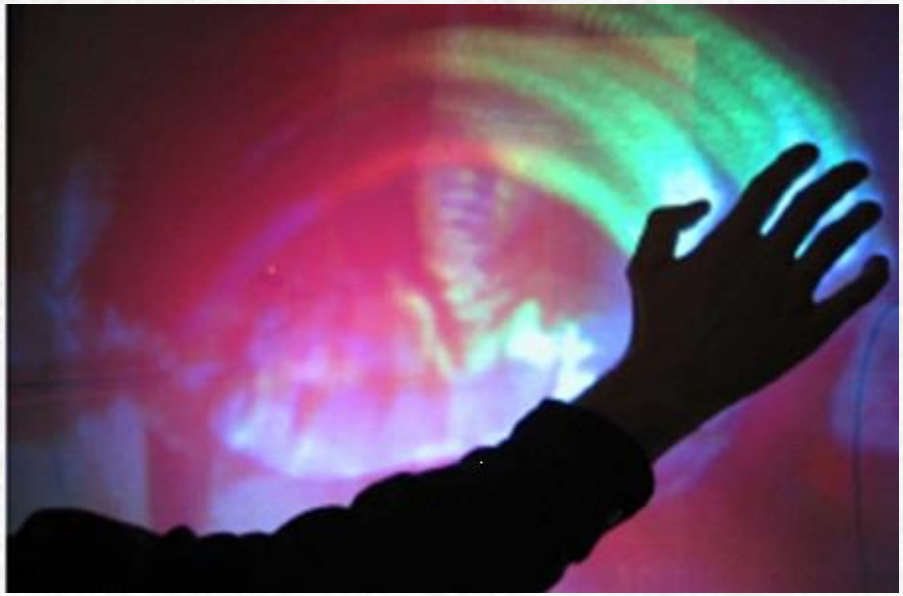
- Although they could not see outside the cabin, they could hear the eerie tapping, tapping, tapping, of his knife upon their door.

Taste



- The cheesecake's exquisite flavor traveled from his tongue to his spine.

Touch



- The icy breeze gently brushed against the hair on her neck, and goose-bumps shortly followed.

Symbol

- •A word or object that has its own meaning and represents another word, object or idea •
- • **Example: The daffodils represent happiness and pleasure to the author.**

Assonance

- •The repetition of a vowel sound in two or more words in the line of a poem •

- • **Example: "Wh_i_ch _i_s the bl_i_ss of sol_i_tude"**

ASSONANCE

- Repeated VOWEL sounds in a line or lines of poetry.

(Often creates near rhyme.)

Lake Fate Base Fade

(All share the long “a” sound.)

ASSONANCE cont.

Examples of ASSONANCE:

"Slow the low gradual moan came in the snowing."

- John Masefield

"Shall ever medicine thee to that sweet sleep."

- William Shakespeare

CONSONANCE

- Similar to alliteration EXCEPT . . .
- The repeated consonant sounds can be anywhere in the words

"silken, sad, uncertain, rustling . . "

Refrain

- •The repetition of one or more phrases or lines at certain intervals, usually at the end of each stanza •Similar to the chorus in a song

Repetition

- •A word or phrase repeated within a line or stanza •
- • **Example: “gazed and gazed”**

POINT OF VIEW IN POETRY

POET

- The poet is the author of the poem.

SPEAKER

- The speaker of the poem is the “narrator” of the poem, technically called the persona.

Poetry Form

- Form is the structure of the poem. Any type of writing must have something to hold it together.

The structure can be created through many means: meter, stanza, rhyme scheme, or set patterns of poetry like sonnet, haiku , concrete, and others.

FREE VERSE POETRY

- Does NOT have rhyme.
- Free verse poetry is very conversational - sounds like someone talking with you.
- A more modern type of poetry.

BLANK VERSE POETRY

from Julius Ceasar

- Written in lines of iambic pentameter, but does NOT use end rhyme.

Cowards die many times before their deaths;

The valiant never taste of death but once.

Of all the wonders that I yet have heard,

It seems to me most strange that men should fear;

Seeing that death, a necessary end,

Will come when it will come.

RHYME

- Words sound alike because they share the same ending vowel and consonant sounds.

- (A word always rhymes with itself.)

LAMP

STAMP

↑ Share the short “a” vowel sound

↑ Share the combined “mp” consonant sound

END RHYME

- A word at the end of one line rhymes with a word at the end of another line

Hector the Collector
Collected bits of ***string***.
Collected dolls with broken heads
And rusty bells that would not ***ring***.

INTERNAL RHYME

- A word inside a line rhymes with another word on the same line.

Once upon a midnight ***dreary***, while I pondered weak and ***weary***.

From “The Raven”
by Edgar Allan Poe

NEAR RHYME

- a.k.a imperfect rhyme, close rhyme

ROSE

LOSE

- The words share EITHER the same vowel or consonant sound BUT NOT BOTH

↑ Different vowel sounds (long “o” and “oo” sound)

↑ Share the same consonant sound

SOME TYPES OF POETRY

LYRIC

- A short poem
- Usually written in first person point of view
- Expresses an emotion or an idea or describes a scene
- Do not tell a story and are often musical
- (Many of the poems we read will be lyrics.)

SHAKESPEAREAN SONNET

A fourteen line poem with a specific rhyme scheme.

The poem is written in three quatrains and ends with a couplet.

The rhyme scheme is

abab cdcd efef gg

Shall I compare thee to a summer' s day?
Thou art more lovely and more temperate.
Rough winds do shake the darling buds of May,
And summer' s lease hath all too short a date.
Sometimes too hot the eye of heaven shines,
And often is his gold complexion dimmed;
And every fair from fair sometimes declines,
By chance or nature' s changing course untrimmed.
But thy eternal summer shall not fade
Nor lose possession of that fair thou ow' st;
Nor shall Death brag thou wanderest in his shade,
When in eternal lines to time thou grow' st
So long as men can breathe or eyes can see,
So long lives this, and this gives life to thee.

NARRATIVE POEMS

- A poem that tells a story.
- Generally longer than the lyric styles of poetry b/c the poet needs to establish characters and a plot.

Examples of Narrative Poems

"The Raven"

"The Highwayman"

"Casey at the Bat"

"The Walrus and the Carpenter"

CONCRETE POEMS

- In concrete poems, the words are arranged to create a picture that relates to the content of the poem.

Poetry
Is like
Flames,
Which are
Swift and elusive
Dodging realization
Sparks, like words on the
Paper, leap and dance in the
Flickering firelight. The fiery
Tongues, formless and shifting
Shapes, tease the imiagination.
Yet for those who see,
Through their mind's
Eye, they burn
Up the page.

OTHER POETIC DEVICES

Hyperbole

- Exaggeration often used for emphasis.

Litotes

- Understatement - basically the opposite of hyperbole. Often it is ironic.
- Ex. Calling a slow moving person “Speedy”

Idiom

- An expression where the literal meaning of the words is not the meaning of the expression. It means something other than what it actually says.

- Ex. It's raining cats and dogs.

Allusion

- Allusion comes from the verb “allude” which means “to refer to”
- An allusion is a reference to something famous.

A tunnel walled and overlaid
With dazzling crystal: we had read
Of rare Aladdin’s wondrous cave,
And to our own his name we gave.

From “Snowbound”
John Greenleaf Whittier